

Question:

A 63-year-old man comes to the physician because of a 2-month history of progressive fatigue. He also has shortness of breath and palpitations, which worsen on physical exertion and improve with rest. He has had intermittent constipation, low-grade fever, and generalized myalgia for the past 3 months. He has had a 10.4-kg (23-lb) weight loss over the past 4 months despite no change in appetite. His temperature is 37°C (98.6°F), pulse is 108/min, respirations are 16/min, and blood pressure is 130/78 mm Hg. Examination shows pale conjunctivae. His hemoglobin concentration is 9.1 g/dL, mean corpuscular volume is 70 μm³, and serum ferritin is 12 ng/mL. Test of the stool for occult blood is positive. Colonoscopy shows a 1.7-cm wide exophytic ulcer with irregular, bleeding edges in the ascending colon. Which of the following biopsy findings is the greatest predisposing factor for this patient's condition? Answer Choices: A. A submucosal lipomatous polyp B. A villous adenomatous polyp C. A serrated hyperplastic polyp D. A tubular adenomatous polyp

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>The patient's symptoms of progressive fatigue, shortness of breath, palpitations, intermittent constipation, low-grade fever, and generalized myalgia, along with the low hemoglobin concentration and serum ferritin level, suggest a possible bleeding disorder leading to iron deficiency anemia, which can be caused by a bleeding polyp in the colon that is ulcerating and causing chronic blood loss, as indicated by the positive stool test for occult blood and the exophytic ulcer with irregular bleeding edges in the ascending colon found on colonoscopy.</think> <answer> B . A villous adenomatous polyp </answer>

